Our name is Melog

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/69182136.

Rating:
Not Rated

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Catra & Melog (She-Ra), (Mentioned) Catra/Adora, (Implied) Catra/Adora, Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra Applesauce Meowmeow - Character, Melog - Character, (Mentioned) Adora Happysmile Rainbowfist, (Mentioned) Glimmer Moon, (Mentioned) Bow Woods

Additional Tags:
Therapy Cat Melog (She-Ra), They/Them pronouns Melog, Melog is NB, Melog refers to themselves using 'us/we/our' and uses names and 'she/her/he/him/they/them' instead of 'you/your', This is how i envision Melog's characterization to be, I also gave Glimmer and Bow last names, because nobles, especially Kings and Princesses and Queens, are generally supposed to have last names, Right?, though it isn't explicitly stated in the fic, Glimmer's last name is Moon, and Bow is Bow Woods, Slice of Life, I think?, Melog is like an ancient being who knows nothing about regular customs, they're clueless, Comparable to modern characterization of biblically accurate angels tbh, yay!

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by ST4RWYNN

Summary

> ❝ "Can you hear it talking? Please tell me you can hear it talking!" Melog has become an essential part of Catra's everyday life, and they often talk about things. ❞
>
> A.K.A; A collection of Melog and Catra interactions
>
> [An She-Ra and the Princesses of Power fanfiction by Starwynn (@ST4RWYNN)]
> [`--` by Starwynn]

Notes

> Listen, I haven't watched the series in a long time so there might be some inconsistencies in dialogue, characterization, timelines or things of the sort.
>
> Also, I've decided to characterize Melog this way--specifically their voice and how they speak--because it feels like a very 'ancient-being' manner of speaking, like how one might imagine a biblically accurate Angel to talk. I have also opted to use they/them pronouns for Melog's character. For a while, I toyed with the idea of Melog's pronouns being it/its but eventually settled on they/them. They refer to themselves as 'us/we/our' and such. Melog with 'typical' she/her or he/him pronouns and 'normal' speech mannerisms didn't really scream Melog for me, so I devised this characterization instead!
>
> Hope you enjoy!
>
> --

Warnings:
- Headcanons
- Possible OOC (Out of Character) She-Ra characters
- Inaccuracies/Inconsistencies
- Slightly dubious timelines

See the end of the work for more notes

Our name is Melog, the strange creature said, poking their nose at Catra.

"Can you hear it talking? Please tell me you can hear it talking!"

--

Catra always considered herself to be more than capable of concealing her emotions. So, understandably, she was alarmed when a talking cat named Melog can read her like a book.

It was unnerving and, admittedly, impressive to find a being who could understand her so easily. Perhaps what she and Melog shared even transcended mere understanding--and it would take a while to get used to.

Catra is thinking too hard, Melog said, nudging Catra's arm, *Stop before you give us a headache.*

Catra scowled at them, curling her tail around her feet. "I'm about to think you into the *sun*," she muttered.

Melog tilted their head, then proceeded to let out a hiss almost identical to Catra's and wrap their tail around their hind paw.

Catra scoffed. This action was rewarded by Melog's voice saying, *Catra is unhappy.*

"*Catra* will happily *throw you at a star* if you don't shut up," Catra retorted huffily, flicking her ear.

We do not understand, Melog said, sniffing at Catra's hair, *What is a 'shut up'? What must we shut and why must we do it upwards?*

Catra rolled her eyes. "You're so stupid."

Uh! Melog sniffed indignantly and pawed Catra's hand, *We are not stupid! We are an ancient being with high levels of intelligence*

and managed to manipulate Catra and her friends. Do not insult us in that manner.

"What manner, then? I take requests."

--

"This isn't because I like you!" Catra grumbled at Adora.

Melog tilted their head. *Why is Catra lying? Does this fool Adora? We are not so easily tricked.*

"Shut *up*!"

We still do not know what that means.

--

Catra would like to sleep next to Adora? Melog purred, padding on Adora's bed, in the free space just below Adora's knees.

Catra shook her head wordlessly. She did not want to speak, for risk of waking any of the friendship-obsessed rebels below her.

Catra does not wish to speak, Melog said, curling up beside Adora, *We do not understand why Catra will not do what she wants.*

Catra bared her teeth at them. She was still getting used to the whole 'Melog-knows-all' thing.

Melog hissed in mild offense. *We do not sound like that,* they put in, *Catra is being unfair. We are only stating that Catra wants to sleep next to Adora.*

"No, I do not," Catra muttered, momentarily forgetting what she said about not waking Adora up.

Yes, Catra does. We know all.

--

"She'll be fine. After the chip, I mean. I've… uh, had some experience," Catra muttered, rubbing the back of her neck.

Catra is feeling awkward, Melog pointed out, making that odd meowing sound of theirs, *Her stress levels have risen.*

Shut up, Melog, Catra thought at them.

We still do not understand what Catra means by 'shut up.'

--

"Hey, Melog?"

Yes, Catra?

Catra pointed at the ship. "Do you think you can make that invisible?" she asked, "I have an idea."

Catra has an idea! Melog said, rearing up on their hind legs, *We will record this momentous occasion in our memory.*

"Very funny," Catra deadpanned, "I'm laughing so hard."

Melog spun around in a circle, shaking their flowy blue mane out. *We do have the ability to shift the ship's state to noncorporeal.*

"Can't you talk like a human for once?"

Melog shook their head and emitted a noise that sounded suspiciously similar to Catra's sneeze*. We are not human. We are sure Catra knows that.*

"Right, right…"

--

Catra? Why is Catra separating us from Adora? Melog asked. *Catra… Catra does not want to leave. So why are we leaving?*

Catra didn't dignify that with a response. She continued walking, trying to put as much distance between her and Adora as possible.

This is hurting Catra, Melog protested, *Adora will not like this!*

"Catra!"

Catra hissed and began running. She was pleased to find that Melog was running too.

Where Catra goes, we go.

--

Is Catra sure about this? Melog asked, tottering over to but their head on Catra's leg.

Catra nodded imperceptibly, turning her gaze away from Adora's tear-streaked face.

Melog made the Melog-equivalent of a frown, and Catra felt their magic engulf her. *We do not advise this, Catra, but we will do what Catra asks.*

--

Why is Catra leaving? Melog asked once again, padding over to trot next to Catra, *We thought that Catra liked Adora.*

"I don't like how she's acting."

Oh. We see. Catra is afraid.

Catra bristled, her tail puffing up as she whirled to face Melog. "I am not *afraid*!"

Catra is afraid. Catra's stress levels are heightened. Is Catra scared of Adora getting hurt?

Catra growled. She wasn't sure she liked Melog's blatant honesty.

We are honest because honest is the right thing. Catra should stay with Adora. We were afraid of our past family getting hurt too, but we stayed. Catra should stay too.

"No. Stop talking."

We want Catra to go back. Catra will be happier.

"I am not going back."

--

Melog came to an abrupt stop. *We cannot do this anymore.*

Catra went flying in a somersault over Melog's head and crashed into the roots of a tree. "Ow!" She cried, "What is *wrong* with you?!"

Melog padded around Catra and started rubbing their head against her cheek. *Catra has to go back to Adora! We insist!*

"No! I told you." Catra pushed Melog away. She felt the odd, water-like texture of Melog's mane, but she had gotten used to it by now. It seemed such a trivial thing to notice.

"I'm not going back."

Hurm. We didn't want to do this, Melog huffed, shaking their mane, *but Catra had forced us to do so.*

Before Catra had any time to respond to that--though she knew what they intended--Melog pounced on her, trapping her between their body and the grass.

Catra grunted, struggling. She felt pressure building in her eyes as tears started to form, and her voice went a pitch higher than she intended.

"You saw what happened!" She cried, turning her face away, her ears flattening against her head, "Adora chose *Shadow Weaver*,

okay?! Not me!"

But Adora wants Catra! Melog protested, *We insist Catra goes back!*

"A-Adora doesn't *want me*," Catra said, her voice cracking despite her best efforts. Her expression softened into regretful wistfulness as she finally admitted something she'd never dared to face before. "…Not… Not like I want *her*."

Melog made one of their stranger meowing noises and licked Catra's cheek. *Adora still wants Catra. Adora needs Catra for this. Please trust us. Catra needs to go back. We will be there if it gets painful for Catra.*

Catra sniffed--once, because that was as much weakness as she would allow herself for one day--and wrapped her arms around Melog's neck.

Does Catra understand now? We know it is painful for Catra, but Adora needs her. If Catra loves Adora, she will be there for Adora.

Catra let out a soft sigh.

--

"Ready for a new adventure, Melog?"

What is Catra referring to?

Catra crouched down and slung one arm over Melog's neck. She made a wide, sweeping motion with her free hand at the new star formations in the sky. "We're going to conquer the universe!"

Melog cast a concerned glance her way. *Catra is going to what?*

"I mean, restore magic to the universe."

Catra jabbed a finger at Adora, Glimmer and Bow. "They're going to. Do you want to come?"

Where Catra goes, we go.

"Great stuff."

End Notes

I hope you enjoyed this short oneshot about Catra and Melog.

I always wondered how they interact--especially considering them being bonded in the way they are, but still remaining separate beings (because I don't think Melog would be an 'extension' of Catra, especially when it's implied that they are older than Catra.)

Comments are always appreciated. Do tell me if you think my characterization of Melog is alright--I tried to make it as close to canon as possible. Or, at least, how I view canon.

Again, I haven't watched the actual show in some time, so I might have skipped over some important scenes or mixed up the timeline a little bit.

Regards,
Starwynn!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!